noted that Kalhana had got the information on Ashoka in the *Rajatarangini* from an earlier author called Chavillakara.[47] In Chavillakara's list, Ashoka figures first in the king list—as he does in Xuanzang's account of Kashmir.

That said, there are similarities as well as differences in how Ashoka was remembered in the twelfth-century chronicle as against Xuanzang's account. Kalhana, like Xuanzang, drew attention to Ashoka's political prowess, clear from the statement that he reigned 'over the earth'.[48] Kalhana drew attention to his religious persona as well: this king had 'freed himself from sins' and 'embraced the doctrine of Jina'.[49] The reference to Jina is exactly how the twelfth-century Sarnath inscription of Govindachandra had referred to the Buddha. While we are uncertain about how this should be contextualized, what seems certain is that the emperor's personal metamorphosis is what the text appears to be hinting at, and this appears to be based on the memory of a reliable older tradition. Ashoka is also chronicled here as a builder. For the first time, however, we hear of him as the founder of a town, Srinagari, not far from present-day Srinagar. This is described with uncharacteristic hyperbole as 'most important on account of its ninety-six lakhs of houses resplendent with wealth.'[50] As for religious structures, there were two places where he built stupas, Suskaletra and Vitastatra; at the latter he also built a chaitya. He is even said to have built Shiva shrines at Vijayeshvara. One of these was in the form of a stone enclosure, which replaced the old enclosure there, and within it he erected two temples. They were called Ashokeshvara, evidently after the king himself.[51] It was also from the god Shiva, whom 'he had pleased by his austerities', that Ashoka obtained a son—who then exterminated the Mlecchas from Kashmir.[52]

Kalhana's account of Ashoka is followed by his description of the exploits of the son, Jalauka, who succeeded him. No such son is mentioned in any other textual source, not even in the list of kings in the *Puranas*. The family name 'Maurya', which figures in other sources that mention the